

Data and a plan, all you need



An open-data river-channel database and a four-step prioritisation method behind the 2026 update of the Czech Concept

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THE DATA FOUNDATION

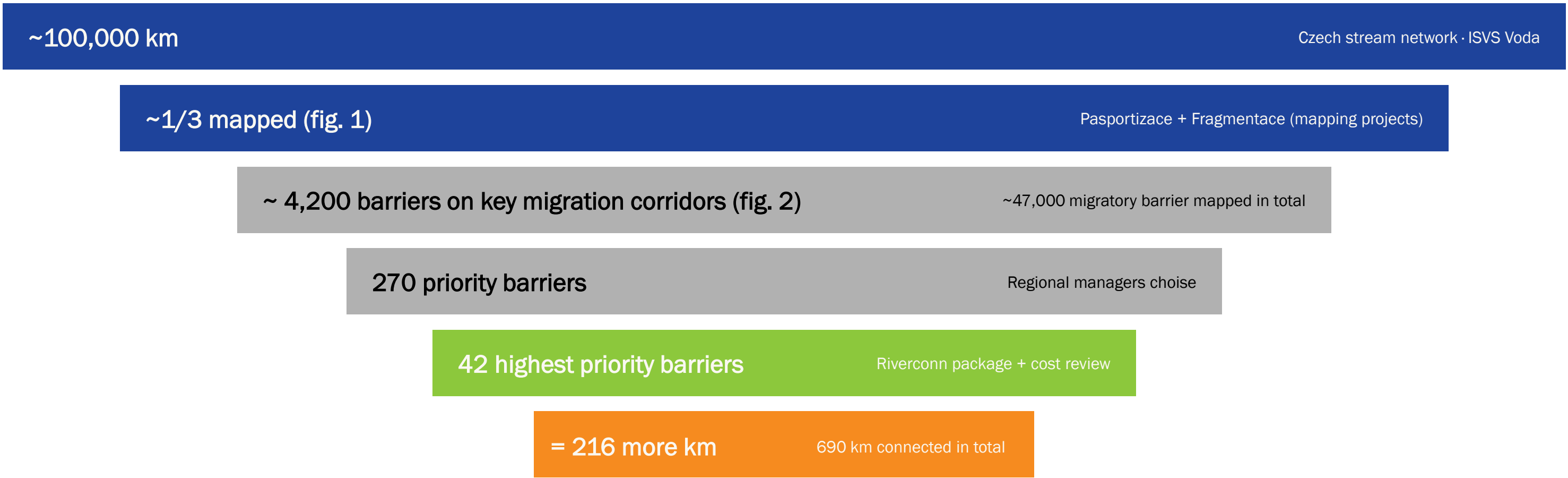
~1/3

of the Czech stream network length is now field-mapped — all open, downloadable, and continuously updated.

THE DECISION-SUPPORT PIPELINE

From a 100,000 km network to a ranked, defensible action list

The new most comprehensive open-data river channels database enables better prioritization of barriers to longitudinal connectivity – main theme of 4th update of The Conception for River Network Passability in the Czech Republic (or just the Czech Concept).



THE RESULT: PRIORITIZATION WORKS

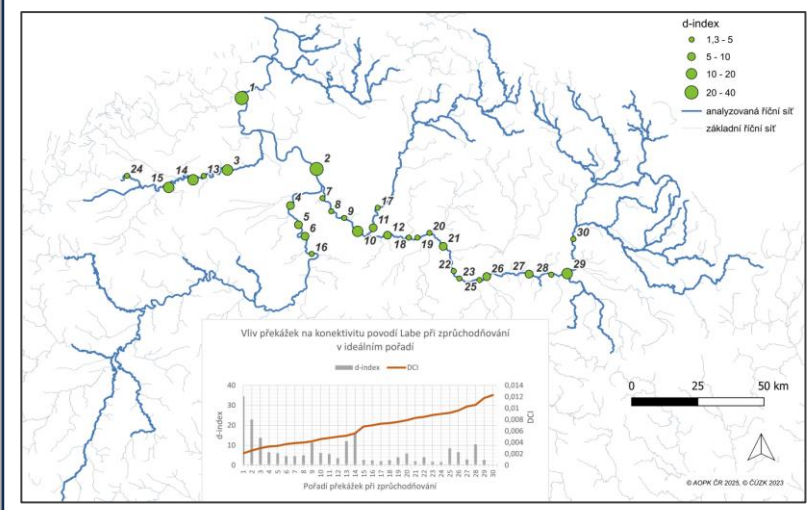
ABOUT THE METHOD

How priorities are selected

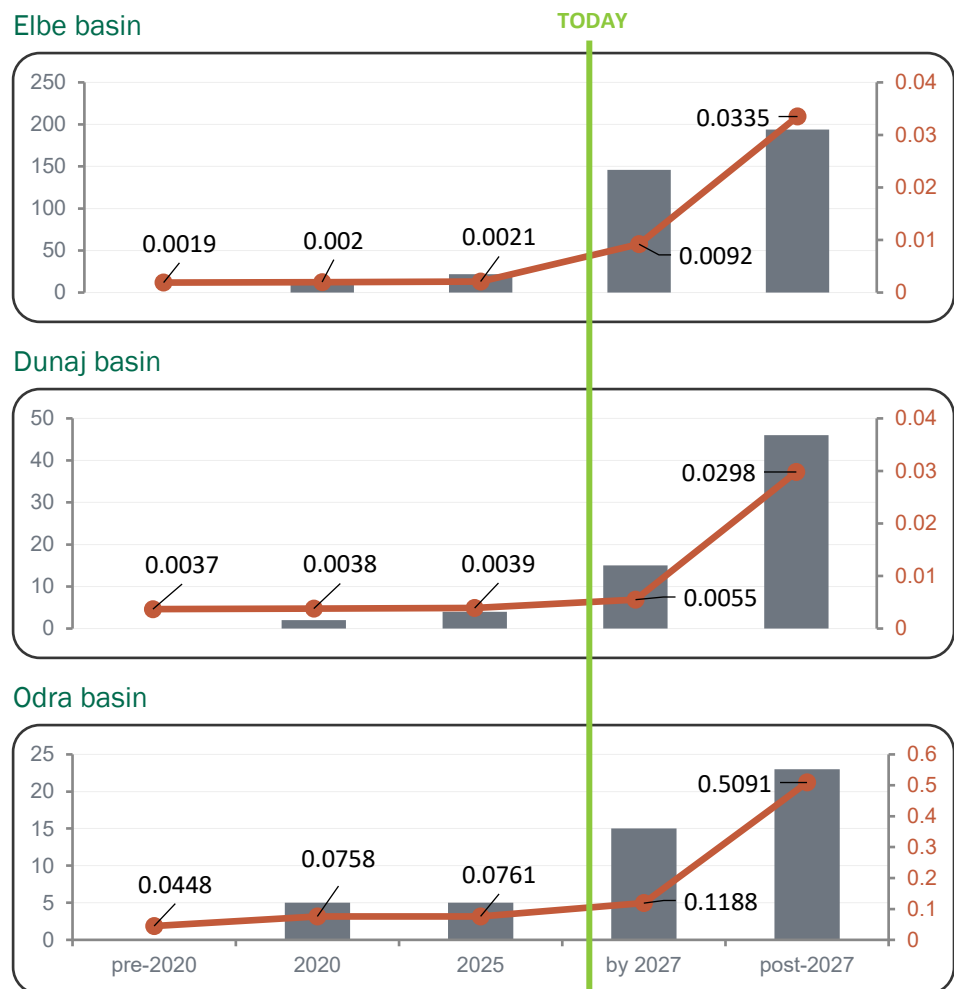
4 step system

1. Let water managers choose barriers above the priority river network.
2. Let regional nature conservation managers choose barriers above the priority river network.
3. Use spatial prioritisation tools (fig. 3).
4. Set the number of priorities, based on financial and resource expectations.

Ideal order of reconnecting Elbe basin (fig. 3)



Cumulative passable priority barriers and Dendritic Connectivity Index changes in time by basin (fig. 4)



66 %

of all new connectivity was produced by just 9 of the 31 barriers passed (2020–2025). The prioritization works.

The 3 takeaways

- **National scale is the operational scale.** EU directives can't pick specific barriers; local managers can't see the whole network. The Concept fills that gap.
- **Prioritisation pays off.** 9 of the 31 barriers passed in 2020–2025 delivered 66% of the new connectivity — far above random selection.
- **Treat the priority list as living.** Without re-ranking, gains stall — the barriers currently lined up for 2027 would not move the connectivity trend (fig. 4).

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github.com/BiodivMonCZ/Koncepcce2026

All analyses, fully reproducible.

Open data and R code behind every number on this poster.

T A
C R

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